



VALLEY OAK CUSTOMS

Design Manager

Quick Start Guide

Version 1.5.0

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Find it. Organize it. Open it. Make it.

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1 What Design Manager is

Design Manager is a Windows organizer and visual browser for CNC files. It catalogs files where they already live and stores organization separately.

- Browse SVG and DXF designs plus related SheetCam JOB, image, TAP, and NC files.
- Search, preview, favorite, tag, collect, and record shop notes.
- Normal organization and migration do not move or change CNC source files. A file changes only when you explicitly confirm a supported file operation.

File safety: Design Manager never executes TAP or NC machine programs.

2 Upgrade install and activate

Run the trusted installer, accept the license agreement, and use Settings > License to activate this PC.

- Existing users can install v1.5.0 over the current public version. Settings, library folders, saved organization, Workflow history, and license state are retained.
- An existing Local Workspace remains Local. Shared migration begins only when you choose it.
- A new installation begins with a trial. Viewer Mode preserves safe access when activation is unavailable.

3 Set Design Library Folders

Open Settings > Design Library Folders, add each top folder containing designs, choose whether to include subfolders, then Refresh.

- Folders remain in their original Windows locations. Removing one from the catalog does not delete it.
- In Local mode, folder exclusions omit selected subfolders from normal scans while preserving files and saved organization.

4 Understand the main screen

Filters are on the left, design cards are in the center, and details and quick actions are on the right.

- Search filenames, folders, tags, notes, and status.
- Select once for details; double-click to open.
- For an SVG or DXF, choose Open Design Workspace to keep the design and its manufacturing files together.

5 Find and organize a design

Select a file, then add a favorite, status, tags, collection, or notes. Wait for Saved automatically before closing.

- Use practical tags such as product type, theme, customer, season, or production readiness.

6 Use Design Workspace

Select an SVG or DXF and choose Open Design Workspace to see the design, shop information, confirmed JOBs, and related TAP or NC programs in one view.

- Confirmed Design to JOB to machine-file connections keep their manufacturing hierarchy. Direct Design to TAP/NC links appear separately.
- Suggested relationships remain clearly marked for review. File status distinguishes available, missing, inaccessible or unverified, and ignored evidence.
- Preview and Reveal use the existing safe file actions. A preview never runs machine code.

7 Review and link related files

Needs Review and All Workflow Files start with the selected design and its confirmed manufacturing context. Choose Show all when you need the global list.

- Confirm good matches. Use Not related when files do not belong together. Saved Relationships retains earlier decisions so they can be reviewed or corrected.
- The manual picker starts with Likely related files. Preview or Show in folder before choosing, or use Show all compatible files for an unusual historical name.
- Mixed-sheet JOBs can link to several Designs. TAP and NC previews are visual inspection only; verify programs in your normal CAM and machine workflow.

8 Use Local or Shared Workspace

Local organization stays on one PC. Shared Workspace gives registered shop PCs common metadata and Workflow relationships.

- The Administrator manages authoritative roots, upgrades, backups, device roles, and Shared settings. Members perform ordinary Shared work.
- A Shared Workspace can define multiple ordered library roots. Map each root on every PC to the path that reaches the same files.
- A designated Recovery Device can restore Administrator control if the Administrator PC is lost.

9 Open designs in LightBurn

Configure and test LightBurn in Settings, then use Open in LightBurn for supported SVG and DXF designs.

- Design Manager passes the selected path to LightBurn without changing the source file. JOB, TAP, and NC files do not use this action.

10 Create a customer proof

Select an SVG or DXF, choose Create Customer Preview, then export a separate PNG.

- The original SVG or DXF remains unchanged.

11 Backups recovery and updates

Open Settings for maintenance and recovery tools.

- Local Back Up / Export protects settings and organization. Shared mode provides Back Up Shared Workspace and isolated restore tools. CNC source folders still need their own backup.
- Repair previews stale references. Export Diagnostics gathers support details without design files.
- Choose Settings > Check for Updates manually. The update endpoint is contacted only when you request the check.

12 Quick troubleshooting

Start with Refresh, clear Search and filters, then verify the drive or network share in Windows.

- Shared offline: restore access, then Refresh. Edits remain read-only while the workspace is unavailable.
- Missing relationship: inspect Needs Review, All Workflow Files, and Saved Relationships.
- Keep separate backups of CNC folders; Design Manager backups contain metadata, not source files.